

Data security

Read

As mentioned in slide 1, “Data security”, there are four primary ways to ensure data security is maintained. These are:

Encryption

Encryption ensures that only the holders of the keys can access the data. An example of this is when you visit a website that is HTTPS. The ‘S’ stands for secure and means it was served over an encrypted channel, so nobody could intercept the message and view what you sent or received

Masking

Masking is the process of replacing data on screen with characters such as an Asterix ‘*’. An example of this is often when you see your credit card on a receipt represented by just the last 4 digits and the rest are shown as *.

Erasure

Erasure is a simple but often overlooked mechanism to protect data. The only way to completely ensure that data is protected is to remove it once you no longer need it, or better yet don’t collect it in the first place. Having a good, automated data deletion policy will ensure you don’t have lots of data lying around which becomes valuable to criminals.

Data resilience

Data resilience is the process of making sure that you have secure and accessible backups in the event that you do have a major incident and need to recover everything. The best way to mitigate a ransomware outbreak without having to pay the ransom is to restore everything they took from your backups.